

Day 4 – Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA) & Authentication Methods

Estimated Time: 1.5–2 hours

Goal: Learn how to secure user accounts with MFA and understand the authentication methods available in Microsoft Entra ID.

Lab 1 – Explore Authentication Methods (20–30 minutes)

Go to:

Microsoft Entra admin center → Protection → Authentication methods

If you don't see it in the menu:

- Use the search bar at the top and search for **Authentication methods**.

Review the available methods:

- Microsoft Authenticator
- FIDO2 Security Keys
- Temporary Access Pass (TAP)
- SMS
- Voice Call

- Email OTP (for guests)

Authentication methods | Policies ...

Default Directory - Microsoft Entra ID Security

Search « + Add external MFA Refresh | Got feedback?

Manage

- Policies**
- Password protection
- Registration campaign
- Authentication strengths
- Settings

Monitoring

- Activity
- User registration details
- Registration and reset events
- Bulk operation results
- Bulk operation results (Preview)

Authentication method policies

Use authentication methods policies to configure the authentication methods your users may register and use. If a user is in scope for a method, they may use it to authenticate and for password reset (some methods aren't supported for some scenarios). [Learn more](#)

Method	Target	Enabled
Built-in		
Passkey (FIDO2)	All users	Yes
Microsoft Authenticator	All users	Yes
SMS		No
Temporary Access Pass	All users	Yes
Hardware OATH tokens (Preview)		No
Software OATH tokens	All users	Yes
Voice call		No
Email OTP	All users	Yes
Certificate-based authentication		No
Verified ID		No
QR code		No

Questions

For each method, answer:

- What is it?
- Is it phishing-resistant?
- When would you use it?

Method	Use Case	Phishing Resistant?
Microsoft Authenticator	Daily employee MFA	No
FIDO2 Security Key	Administrators	Yes
Temporary Access Pass	Onboarding or recovery	No
SMS	Basic MFA	No
Voice Call	Legacy fallback	No

Lab 2 – Enable Microsoft Authenticator (30 minutes)

Go to:

Protection → Authentication methods → Policies → Microsoft Authenticator

Verify:

- Microsoft Authenticator is **Enabled**.
- Target includes **All users** (or your test users).

If you're using a free Microsoft Entra tenant, some policy options may not be available. If so, document that limitation in your README.

Home > Authentication methods | Policies

Microsoft Authenticator settings

The Microsoft Authenticator app is a flagship authentication method, usable in passwordless or simple push notification approval modes. The app is free to download and use on Android/iOS mobile devices. [Learn more](#).

Enable and Target Configure

Enable ☒

Include Exclude

Target ☒ All users ☐ Select groups

Name	Type	Registration	Authentication mode
All users	Group	Optional	Any

Lab 3 – Register MFA for a Test User (30–40 minutes)

Choose **John Smith** (or another test account).

1. Open an Incognito/InPrivate browser.
2. Sign in as the test user.
3. If prompted, register **Microsoft Authenticator**.
4. Install the Microsoft Authenticator app on your phone if needed.
5. Complete the registration.

Observe

- What prompts appear?
- How does the user verify their identity?

If your free tenant doesn't enforce registration, note that in your documentation.

Lab 4 – Compare Authentication Methods

(20 minutes)

Create a comparison table.

Method	Security	Ease of Use	Best For
Password	Low	Easy	Not recommended alone
SMS	Medium	Easy	Small organizations
Authenticator	High	Easy	Most users
FIDO2	Very High	Medium	Administrators
TAP	Medium	Easy	Account recovery

Home > Authentication methods | Policies

SMS settings

This authentication method delivers a one-time code via SMS to a user's phone, and the user then inputs that code to sign-in. [Learn more.](#)
SMS is usable for multi-factor authentication and Self-Service Password Reset; it can also be configured to be used as a first factor.

Enable and Target

Enable

Include

Exclude

Target

All users

Select groups

Name	Type	Use for sign-in	Registration
All users	Group	☐	Optional

Home > Authentication methods | Policies

Microsoft Authenticator settings

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Enable and Target

Configure

Enable

Include

Exclude

Target

All users

Select groups

Name	Type	Registration	Authentication mode
All users	Group	Optional	Any

Passkey (FIDO2) settings

Passkeys (FIDO2) Authentication Methods

Passkey profiles are now available. Your previous passkey settings have been moved into the default passkey profile. Up to 10 passkey profiles are supported at this time. [Learn more](#)

Passkeys are a phishing-resistant, standards-based passwordless authentication method that can be stored on a variety of security key models or passkey providers. Passkeys are not usable in the self-service password reset flow. [Learn more](#)

Enable and target Configure

Enable ☒ On

Include Exclude

+ Add target

Name	Type	Passkey profiles
All users	Group	Default passkey profile

Alex Brown | Authentication methods

User

Search + Add authentication method Reset password Require re-register multifactor authentication Revoke sessions View authentication methods policy Got feedback?

- Overview
- Audit logs
- Sign-in logs
- Diagnose and solve problems
- Custom security attributes
- Assigned roles
- Administrative units
- Groups
- Applications
- Licenses
- Devices
- Azure role assignments
- Authentication methods
- New support request

The Revoke multifactor authentication sessions control has been updated. Learn more at <https://aka.ms/RevokeSessions>.

Authentication methods are the ways users sign into Microsoft Entra ID and perform self-service password reset (SSPR). The user's "default sign-in method" is the first one shown to the user when they are required to authenticate with a second factor - the user always can choose another registered, enabled authentication method to authenticate with. [Learn more](#)

Default sign-in method (Preview) No default

Usable authentication methods

Authentication method	Detail
Temporary Access Pass	Expires at 7/22/2026, 9:45:06 AM

Non-usable authentication methods

Authentication method	Detail
No non-usable methods.	

System preferred multifactor authentication method

Feature status	System preferred MFA method
Enabled	No system preferred MFA method